THE BLACKHEARTS

Crafting, Materials & Equipment — Consolidated Rules
Blood, Coin, and Betrayal

I. Universal Grading System

All materials, equipment and finished products—whether found, bought, looted or crafted—use the same percentile grading scale. Material category, the individual quality of a sample, and the craftsmanship of the finished item are distinct characteristics.

Grade	Percentile
POOR	1–25%
FAIR	26–40%
GOOD	41–80%
MASTERWORK	81–95%
INCREDIBLE (Legendary tier)	96–100%

The term Legendary is used below for the Incredible-tier equipment benefits. The fifth percentile band remains Incredible. A roll of exactly 80% is Good; Masterwork begins at 81%.

II. Materials: Category, Quality & Limitations

A material has an inherent category and an individual quality percentage. For example, 100%-quality copper is an exceptional sample of copper, but copper remains a Poor-category metal. Exceptional purity does not turn copper into iron or steel.

Material	Inherent category	Notes
Stone, flint, granite, obsidian, bone	Natural / Poor weapon performance	Includes natural rock, glass and bone; specific uses vary
Copper	Poor	Soft, easily repaired
Bronze	Fair	Easily repaired
Iron	Good	Standard metal
Steel	Masterwork	Superior, costly to repair
Mithril, Orichalcum, etc.	Incredible / Legendary	Rare; individual properties discovered in play

Nonmetal armor—leather, wood, bone, hides and other materials—has its own material categories and individual quality ratings, to be established separately. Not every material is suitable for every design.

III. Metal & Natural Weapon Properties

These modifiers come from the material type and apply in addition to individual material quality and craftsmanship effects.

Material	Attack / damage	Durability / repair
Natural (stone, bone, obsidian, etc.)	One damage-die step smaller than listed (e.g., d6 → d4)	Poor durability; cannot be repaired after damage
Copper	One damage-die step smaller; −1 to hit	Poor durability; easily repaired
Bronze	−1 to hit and −1 damage	Fair durability; easily repaired
Iron	No modifier	Good / standard durability; easily repaired
Steel	+1 to hit OR +1 damage	Masterwork durability; repairable at high cost
Legendary metals	Unique, material-specific effects	Unique, revealed in play

A damage-die step means moving down one die magnitude; the exact sequence and treatment of the smallest die will be specified by the DM. Natural weapons and armor that become damaged are not repairable.

IV. Material Quality & Finished Craftsmanship

The individual quality of the material and the craftsmanship result are separate grades. Their bonuses are cumulative with the inherent material properties above. The following table gives the item-quality modifiers used for each applicable quality layer.

Quality grade	Hit / damage modifier	Maximum durability
Poor	−1 to hit AND −1 damage	50% (−50 percentage points)
Fair	−1 to hit OR −1 damage	75% (−25 points)
Good	No modifier	100% (baseline)
Masterwork	+1 to hit OR +1 damage	125% (+25 points)
Incredible / Legendary	+1 to hit AND +1 damage; possible additional traits	150% (+50 points)

Where a choice is offered between hit and damage, select one, not both, for that particular bonus. Additional traits depend on the material. Durability percentages stack additively against baseline durability, not multiplicatively. Any final durability value and any cap remain subject to the DM's rules for material suitability and crafter aptitude.

V. Worked Example: Masterwork Steel Weapon

A weapon is made from steel (inherently Masterwork), using an individual steel sample of Masterwork quality, and achieves a craftsmanship result of 83% (Masterwork).

Source	Combat bonus	Durability contribution
Steel material	+1 to hit OR damage	+25 percentage points
Masterwork material quality	+1 to hit OR damage	+25 percentage points
83% Masterwork craftsmanship	+1 to hit OR damage	+25 percentage points
FINAL	Three +1 bonuses allocated between hit and damage	100% + 25% + 25% + 25% = 175%

The weapon therefore has 175% of standard maximum durability and any allocation of +3 total between hit and damage (for example, +2 hit/+1 damage, or +1 hit/+2 damage).

VI. Metal Armor, Shields & Helmets

Metal armor uses the same material hierarchy. The following are inherent metal-material effects; individual material quality and craftsmanship may further modify the final item. These rules apply to body armor, shields, helmets and other applicable armor pieces.

Material	Armor Class effect	Durability
Copper (Poor)	−2 AC; AC cannot fall below 1	Poor
Bronze (Fair)	−1 AC; AC cannot fall below 1	Fair
Iron (Good)	No bonus or penalty	Standard
Steel (Masterwork)	+1 AC	Masterwork
Legendary metal	Unique material-specific benefits	Material-specific

Armor craftsmanship and quality use the same general grading principle, with appropriate armor penalties or AC improvements in place of weapon hit/damage effects. The detailed mapping of every armor quality grade, and how multiple worn pieces interact, will be finalized by the DM.

VII. Durability, Destruction & Repairs

Equipment condition matters. At 0 durability, an item is permanently destroyed, whether through use or neglect. Repair must occur before it reaches zero. Natural equipment such as stone, bone and obsidian cannot be repaired once damaged.

A repairer must be within one grade of the item's quality to attempt a repair. For example, a Poor armorsmith cannot repair Good armor; a Good item requires at least a Fair-quality smith.

Repair circumstances	Permanent reduction to maximum durability
Same-quality repairer	−1 maximum durability point per repair
Repairer one grade below item	−2 maximum durability points per repair
Higher-quality repairer	Chance of no permanent reduction; chance improves with each grade above the item

The specific probability of avoiding degradation when using a superior repairer, the repair cost, and the item's base durability-point scale will be established in the detailed repair rules. Repair eligibility still applies, and the item cannot be restored after destruction.

VIII. Crafting Procedure & Appraisal

Crafting uses a d100 roll plus modifiers from materials, crafter aptitude, and miscellaneous additions such as gemstones, rare powders and unusual components. The final result determines the workmanship grade, subject to limitations from the materials and the crafter's capabilities.

Crafting result = d100 + material modifiers + crafter modifiers + miscellaneous modifiers. A detailed modifier list and maximum-quality caps will follow. For illustration, a roll of 40 with +40 total modifiers gives 80%, which is Good under the finalized thresholds.

Item quality is not automatically apparent. A character must succeed on a relevant skill check or consult a knowledgeable professional to identify a material or evaluate an item. A jeweler might use a magnifier to assess a gem's purity and cut; a smith may judge a blade's metal and workmanship.

IX. Unusual Materials & Creative Crafting

Players are encouraged to experiment. A large sharp tooth, rare hide, strange timber, unusual ore or recovered mineral might be the basis for a weapon, armor component or specialized tool. Have the material appraised, learn its quality and properties, then find a capable artisan. The DM decides feasibility, applicable bonuses, possible special traits and the risks of failure.

X. Rules Still to Be Detailed

Further supplements will establish base durability points, degradation probabilities for superior smiths, repair costs, precise armor-quality modifiers, material-quality roll modifiers, crafting aptitude and caps, special effects, and additional traits of legendary materials. Until then, the DM adjudicates those cases.

Fine equipment is an investment. In the Gloombough, a well-kept blade may outlast its owner—and a neglected one may fail at the worst possible moment.